



Your Global Research Partner

SECTOR
TRAVEL & LEISURE

CLIENT
**A Leading European
Airline Alliance**

GEOGRAPHIES
COVERED
**France, Germany &
Spain**

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STUDY BACKGROUND

Markelytics conducted a study for a leading European airline alliance to understand how loyalty is being redefined among frequent flyers. The five-week research surveyed over 750 travelers across France, Germany, and Spain through online questionnaires and conjoint analysis to evaluate what drives repeat bookings, balancing price, convenience, personalization, and digital experience in an evolving travel landscape.

BUSINESS OBJECTIVE

To redefine airline loyalty program strategies by identifying what frequent European travelers value most in terms of price, convenience, personalization, and digital experience. The goal was to guide alliance members in refining reward structures, strengthening app and web engagement, and optimizing brand partnerships to improve retention and advocacy.

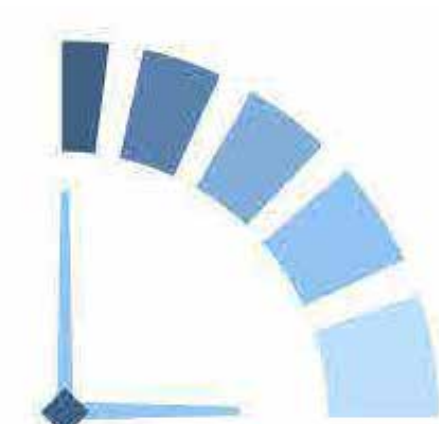
RESEARCH OBJECTIVE

The research aimed to:

- Assess the current effectiveness of airline loyalty programs
- Identify emotional and functional loyalty triggers among frequent flyers
- Evaluate cross-brand travel preferences involving airlines, hotels, and payment cards
- Understand how digital experience and app usability impact repeat bookings and satisfaction

SAMPLE SIZE

750+ Frequent Flyers



5 Weeks

TIMELINE



TARGET RESPONDENTS

Frequent flyers who had undertaken at least three air journeys in the past six months for business or leisure.

METHODOLOGY ADOPTED

The study followed a quantitative research design supported by conjoint analysis to identify the most influential loyalty attributes.

Recruitment and data collection were carried out through:

1. Email sampling using verified frequent flyer databases
2. On-site recruitment at airport lounges and through travel association net works
3. Digital incentives to improve participation among high-frequency travellers

OPERATIONAL CHALLENGES

Engaging time-constrained business travelers across multiple countries while ensuring balanced representation was challenging. Initial response rates were low due to overlapping loyalty memberships and survey fatigue. Variation in loyalty familiarity across markets also affected early progress.

OUR APPROACH TO OPERATIONAL CHALLENGES

To address these issues, Markelytics collaborated with airport lounges and frequent flyer associations in Paris, Frankfurt, and Madrid to access verified traveler lists. A phased rollout approach was adopted, starting with high-traffic business hubs followed by outreach through local travel associations. Mobile-friendly survey formats, multilingual options, and e-voucher incentives were used to enhance participation. A soft-launch validation ensured balanced representation across travel tiers and countries before full deployment.